in the longterm ‘Guided Missile Development Programme’. I had read somewhere, “Know where you are going. The great thing in the world is not knowing so much where we stand, as in what direction we are moving.” What if we did not have the technological might of the Western countries, we knew we had to attain that might, and this determination was our driving force. To draw up a clear and wel -defined missile development programme for the production of indigenous missiles, a committee was constituted under my chairmanship. The members were ZP Marshal , then the Chief of Bharat Dynamics Limited, Hyderabad, NR Iyer, AK Kapoor and KS Venkataraman. We drafted a paper for the perusal of the Cabinet Committee for Political Affairs (CCPA). The paper was given its final shape after consulting the representatives of the three Defence Services. We estimated an expenditure of about Rs 390 crores, spread over a period of twelve years.

Development programmes often get stuck by the time they reach the production stage, mainly because of lack of funding. We wanted to get funds to develop and produce two missiles—a low-level quick reaction Tactical Core Vehicle and a Medium Range Surface-to-Surface Weapon